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Aetna Non-Medicare Prescription Drug Plan

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Subject: Weight Loss (BMI 35) GIP-GLP-1 GLP-1 Agonists PA with Limit 6450-C UDR 05-2024

Drug

WEIGHT LOSS MANAGEMENT

SAXENDA (*liraglutide injection*)

WEGOVY (*semaglutide injection*)

ZEPBOUND (*tirzepatide injection*)

Note:

**Drugs that are listed in the target drug box include both brand and generic and all dosage forms and strengths unless otherwise stated. OTC products are not included unless otherwise stated.*

Policy:

FDA-APPROVED INDICATIONS

Saxenda

Saxenda is indicated as an adjunct to a reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity for chronic weight management in:

- Adult patients with an initial body mass index (BMI) of:
 - 30 kg/m² or greater (obese), or
 - 27 kg/m² or greater (overweight) in the presence of at least one weight-related

comorbid

condition (e.g., hypertension, type 2 diabetes mellitus, or dyslipidemia)

- Pediatric patients aged 12 years and older with:
 - body weight above 60 kg and
 - an initial BMI corresponding to 30 kg/m² or greater for adults (obese) by

international cut-

offs (Cole Criteria)

Limitations of Use

- Saxenda contains liraglutide and should not be coadministered with other liraglutide-containing products or with any other GLP-1 receptor agonist.
- The safety and effectiveness of Saxenda in pediatric patients with type 2 diabetes have not been established.

- The safety and effectiveness of Saxenda in combinations with other products intended for weight loss, including prescription drugs, over-the-counter drugs, and herbal preparations, have not been established.

Wegovy

Wegovy is indicated in combination with a reduced calorie diet and increased physical activity:

- to reduce the risk of major adverse cardiovascular events (cardiovascular death, non-fatal myocardial infarction, or non-fatal stroke) in adults with established cardiovascular disease and either obesity or overweight.
- to reduce excess body weight and maintain weight reduction long term in:
 - Adults and pediatric patients aged 12 years and older with obesity
 - Adults with overweight in the presence of at least one weight-related comorbid condition.

Limitation of Use

- Wegovy contains semaglutide. Coadministration with other semaglutide-containing products or with any other GLP-1 receptor agonist is not recommended.

Zepbound

Zepbound is indicated as an adjunct to a reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity for chronic weight management in adults with an initial body mass index (BMI) of:

- 30 kg/m² or greater (obesity) or
- 27 kg/m² or greater (overweight) in the presence of at least one weight-related comorbid condition (e.g., hypertension, dyslipidemia, type 2 diabetes mellitus, obstructive sleep apnea, or cardiovascular disease).

Limitations of Use

- Zepbound contains tirzepatide. Coadministration with other tirzepatide-containing products or with any glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) receptor agonist is not recommended.
- The safety and efficacy of Zepbound in combination with other products intended for weight management, including prescription drugs, over-the-counter drugs, and herbal preparations, have not been established.
- Zepbound has not been studied in patients with a history of pancreatitis.

COVERAGE CRITERIA

Chronic Weight Management (Adult)

Authorization may be granted when the requested drug will be used with a reduced calorie diet and increased physical activity for chronic weight management when ALL of the following criteria are met:

- The patient is 18 years of age or older
- The patient has participated in a comprehensive weight management program that

encourages

behavioral modification, reduced calorie diet, and increased physical activity with

continuing

follow-up for at least 6 months prior to using drug therapy

- The patient has a baseline body mass index (BMI) greater than or equal to 35

kg/m² [ACTION

REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]

Chronic Weight Management (Pediatric) – Saxenda and Wegovy ONLY

Authorization may be granted when the requested drug will be used with a reduced calorie diet and increased physical activity for chronic weight management when ALL of the following criteria are met:

- The patient is 12 to 17 years of age
- The patient has participated in a comprehensive weight management program that

encourages

behavioral modification, reduced calorie diet, and increased physical activity with

continuing

follow-up for at least 6 months prior to using drug therapy

- If the request is for Saxenda (liraglutide), then ALL of the following criteria are met:
 - The patient has a body weight above 60 kg [ACTION REQUIRED:

Documentation is

required for approval.]

- The patient has a baseline body mass index (BMI) corresponding to 30 kg/m² or

greater for

adults by international cut-off points based on the Cole Criteria [ACTION

REQUIRED:

Documentation is required for approval.]

- If the request is for Wegovy (semaglutide), then the following criteria is met:
 - The patient has a baseline BMI in the 95th percentile or greater standardized for

age and

sex (obesity) [ACTION REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]

Risk Reduction of Major Adverse Cardiovascular Events (Adult) – Wegovy ONLY

Authorization may be granted when the requested drug will be used to reduce the risk of major adverse cardiovascular events (cardiovascular death, non-fatal myocardial infarction (MI), or non-fatal stroke) in an adult with established cardiovascular disease AND either obesity or overweight when ALL of the following criteria are met:

- The request is for Wegovy (semaglutide)
- The requested drug is being used with a reduced calorie diet and increased physical

activity

- The patient has established cardiovascular disease with a history of ONE of the following:

previous MI; previous stroke; symptomatic peripheral arterial disease (PAD), as

evidenced by

intermittent claudication with ankle-brachial index (ABI) less than 0.85 (at rest),

peripheral

arterial revascularization procedure, or amputation due to atherosclerotic disease;

prior history

of revascularization (coronary artery bypass grafting (CABG), percutaneous

coronary

intervention (PCI), or angioplasty) [ACTION REQUIRED: Documentation is required

for

approval.]

- The patient has a baseline body mass index (BMI) greater than or equal to 27

kg/m2 [ACTION

REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]

- The patient does NOT have type 2 diabetes [NOTE: Ozempic is indicated to reduce the risk of major cardiovascular events in adults with type 2 diabetes mellitus and established cardiovascular disease. Patients with type 2 diabetes may be treated for risk reduction of cardiovascular events with Ozempic.]
- The patient is currently receiving guideline-directed management and therapy (GDMT) for cardiovascular disease (e.g., lipid-lowering agent, antiplatelet, beta-blocker, renin-angiotensin inhibitor, etc.) OR the patient has clinical reason not to be treated with GDMT for cardiovascular disease [ACTION REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]

CONTINUATION OF THERAPY

Chronic Weight Management (Adult)

Authorization may be granted when the requested drug will be used with a reduced calorie diet and increased physical activity for chronic weight management when ALL of the following criteria are met:

- The patient is 18 years of age or older
- The patient had a baseline body mass index (BMI) greater than or equal to 35 kg/m2 at the start of drug therapy for weight loss [ACTION REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]
- If the request is for Saxenda (liraglutide), then ALL of the following criteria are met:
 - The patient has completed at least 16 weeks of therapy with the requested drug
 - The patient has lost at least 4 percent of baseline body weight OR the patient has continued to maintain their initial 4 percent weight loss [ACTION REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]
- If the request is for Wegovy (semaglutide), then ALL of the following criteria are met:
 - The patient has completed at least 3 months of therapy with the requested drug at a stable maintenance dose
 - The patient has lost at least 5 percent of baseline body weight OR the patient has continued to maintain their initial 5 percent weight loss [ACTION REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]
- If the request is for Zepbound (tirzepatide), then ALL of the following criteria are met:
 - The patient has completed at least 3 months of therapy with the requested drug at a stable maintenance dose
 - The patient has lost at least 5 percent of baseline body weight OR the patient has continued to maintain their initial 5 percent weight loss [ACTION REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]

Chronic Weight Management (Pediatric) – Saxenda and Wegovy ONLY

Authorization may be granted when the requested drug will be used with a reduced

calorie diet and increased physical activity for chronic weight management when ALL of the following criteria are met:

- The patient is 12 to 17 years of age
- If the request is for Saxenda (liraglutide), then ALL of the following criteria are met:
 - The patient had a baseline body mass index (BMI) corresponding to 30 kg/m²

or greater

for adults by international cut-off points based on the Cole Criteria at the start

of drug

therapy for weight loss [ACTION REQUIRED: Documentation is required for

approval.]

- The patient has completed at least 12 weeks of therapy on the maintenance

dose with

the requested drug

- The patient has had at least 1 percent reduction in BMI from baseline OR the

patient has

continued to maintain their initial 1 percent reduction in BMI from baseline

[ACTION

REQUIRED: Documentation is required for approval.]

- If the request is for Wegovy (semaglutide), then ALL of the following criteria are met:

- The patient had a baseline BMI in the 95th percentile or greater standardized

for age and

sex (obesity) at the start of drug therapy for weight loss [ACTION

REQUIRED:

Documentation is required for approval.]

- The request is for continuation of therapy for a patient that has successfully

titrated to a

stable maintenance dose

- The patient has had a reduction from their baseline BMI OR the patient has

continued to

maintain their reduction in BMI from baseline [ACTION REQUIRED:

Documentation is

required for approval.]

Risk Reduction of Major Adverse Cardiovascular Events (Adult) – Wegovy ONLY

Authorization may be granted when the requested drug will be used to reduce the risk of major adverse cardiovascular events (cardiovascular death, non-fatal myocardial infarction (MI), or non-fatal stroke) in an adult with established cardiovascular disease AND either obesity or overweight when ALL of the following criteria are met:

- The request is for Wegovy (semaglutide)
- The requested drug is being used with a reduced calorie diet and increased physical

activity

- The patient has established cardiovascular disease with a history of ONE of the

following:

previous MI; previous stroke; symptomatic peripheral arterial disease (PAD), as

evidenced by

intermittent claudication with ankle-brachial index (ABI) less than 0.85 (at rest),

peripheral

arterial revascularization procedure, or amputation due to atherosclerotic disease;

prior history

of revascularization (coronary artery bypass grafting (CABG), percutaneous

coronary

intervention (PCI), or angioplasty)

- The patient is being treated with a maintenance dosage of the requested drug

QUANTITY LIMITS APPLY**QUANTITY LIMIT**

Drug	Dosage	1 Month Limit	3 Month Limit
Saxenda (liraglutide)	18 mg / 3 mL (provides variable dosing)	15 mL (1 package of five 3 mL pens) / 25 days*	45 mL (3 packages of five 3 mL pens each) / 75 days*
	0.25 mg / 0.5 mL		
	0.5 mg / 0.5 mL	2 mL (1 package of 4 pens each) / 21 days**	6 mL (3 packages of 4 pens each) / 63 days**
Wegovy (semaglutide)	1 mg / 0.5 mL		
	1.7 mg / 0.75 mL		
	2.4 mg / 0.75 mL	3 mL (1 package of 4 pens each) / 21 days**	9 mL (3 packages of 4 pens each) / 63 days**
Zepbound (tirzepatide)	2.5 mg / 0.5 mL		
	5 mg / 0.5 mL		
	7.5 mg / 0.5 mL	2 mL (1 package of 4 pens each or 4 single-dose vials) / 21 days**	6 mL (3 packages of 4 pens each or 12 single-dose vials) / 63 days**
	10 mg / 0.5 mL		
	12.5 mg / 0.5 mL		
	15 mg / 0.5 mL		

*The duration of 25 days is used for a 30-day fill period and 75 days is used for a 90-day fill period to allow time for refill processing.

**The duration of 21 days is used for a 28-day fill period and 63 days is used for an 84-day fill period to allow time for refill processing.

DURATION OF APPROVAL (DOA)

•6450-C:

°Saxenda:

•Adults: Initial therapy DOA: 4 months; Continuation of therapy DOA: 12 months

•Pediatrics: Initial therapy DOA: 5 months; Continuation of therapy DOA: 12 months

°Wegovy: Initial therapy DOA: 7 months; Continuation of therapy DOA: 12 months

°Zepbound: Initial therapy DOA: 8 months; Continuation of therapy DOA: 12 months

Place of Service:

Outpatient

The above policy is based on the following references:

1. Saxenda [package insert]. Plainsboro, NJ: Novo Nordisk Inc.; April 2023.
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6. Jensen MD, Ryan DH, Apovian DM, et al. 2013 AHA/ACC/TOS Guideline for the Management of Overweight and Obesity in Adults A Report of the American College of Cardiology/American Heart Association Task Force on Practice Guidelines and the Obesity Society. *Circulation*. 2014;129(suppl 2):S102-S138.
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10. Kleindorfer DO, Towfighi A, Chaturvedi S, et al. 2021 Guideline for the Prevention of Stroke in Patients With Stroke and Transient Ischemic Attack: A Guideline From the American Heart Association/American Stroke Association. *Stroke*. 2021;52(7):e364-e467.
11. Gerhard-Herman MD, Gornik HL, Barrett C, et al. 2016 AHA/ACC Guideline on the Management of Patients with Lower Extremity Peripheral Artery Disease: A Report of the American College of Cardiology/American Heart Association Task Force on Clinical Practice Guidelines. *Circulation*. 2017;135(12):e726-e779.

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